

end of the wire, then read the meter. If you get a reading, the black wire is hot; if you do not, the black wire is not. Repeat the test on the other black wire to test if it is hot or not.

When washing machines cease working

The first thing to check is the motor. For this, disconnect the washing machine from its electrical socket, and disassemble the shell. Locate the two wire leads that connect to the motor housing, and remove these by unplugging from the motor. Turn the dial on your multimeter or select the appropriate button for testing resistance.

Place one probe of your multimeter onto each of the metal tabs on the motor that were exposed by unplugging the wires. The multimeter should show zero or a very low number. If it does, motor coils are functional. If it shows a high num-

ber or shows infinite, it indicates the motor is defective.

Remove one probe from the electrical terminal and place it on the shell of the motor to test the ground. If the meter reflects anything other than zero, this means that the motor is not grounded properly.

Once you complete this test, reverse the probes on the motor and test the other lug on the electrical terminal.

Trouble with the water heater

Checking your water heater power is the first thing you should do if you have a problem with your electric hot-water heater. Most residential electric water heaters use 230 volts, but it is better to confirm the voltage rating on the label.

Shut down all circuit breakers before removing the access panels. Check if the reset button has tripped off; if so, simply resetting it should

restore normal functioning of your water heater.

Checking the power supply. Set the water heater's thermostat to its highest temperature setting. Turn the power supply to the water heater back on. Turn on the multimeter and set it to voltage-measuring mode. Connect the two probes of the multimeter to the two wires above the reset button. Reading on the voltmeter should be around 230 volts.

If the voltage reads close to zero, then there is a problem with the power supply to the water heater. If the voltage reads around 230 volts, then the power supply is fine and you will have to check the thermostat.

Now that you are set to be a DIY technician, we hope that you make good use of your new-found skills. Please be careful, though. You are dealing with a huge amount of electricity, so take extra care while dealing with high-power devices. **EFY**



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